Feasibility Iteration 1

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Team Bio



Char Davis



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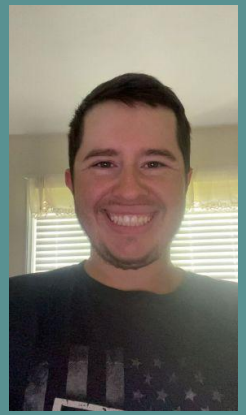
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Elevator Pitch

There are not many easy or convenient ways for students to communicate informally with their classmates outside of class. Classes Together would create a convenient space for informal academic discussion and streamline invitations.

High-Level Overview

Classes Together is a web-based platform that provides students with course-specific communities for informal academic discussion and collaboration. Students would sign in using their university credentials and automatically see communities for their enrolled courses, eliminating the need to manually create group chats or send invitations. These communities would allow students to ask questions, share resources, and communicate with classmates throughout the semester. The prototype will use mock enrollment data instead of a live university integration.

Problem Statement

Class websites such as Canvas, Blackboard, or Google Classroom are for formal academic discussions, whereas informal instant messaging apps, such as Discord, GroupMe, or WhatsApp, require manual invitation of every member. New accounts would have to be created for each student, and not every student would want to join a third-party platform that is not originally intended for academics. Students may also miss invitations.

Problem Characteristics

1. Peer collaborations supports learning
    a. Students can ask each other for questions, explain difficult concepts, and/or share different perspectives outside of lectures.
2. Communication helps students feel connected
    a. Interactions with classmates can help students develop a sense of belonging within their local community.
3. Connecting with classmates can be harder online
    a. Online student will have a lot fewer opportunities to meet classmates and develop relationships through casual interactions, like in-person interactions that students would get face-to-face.

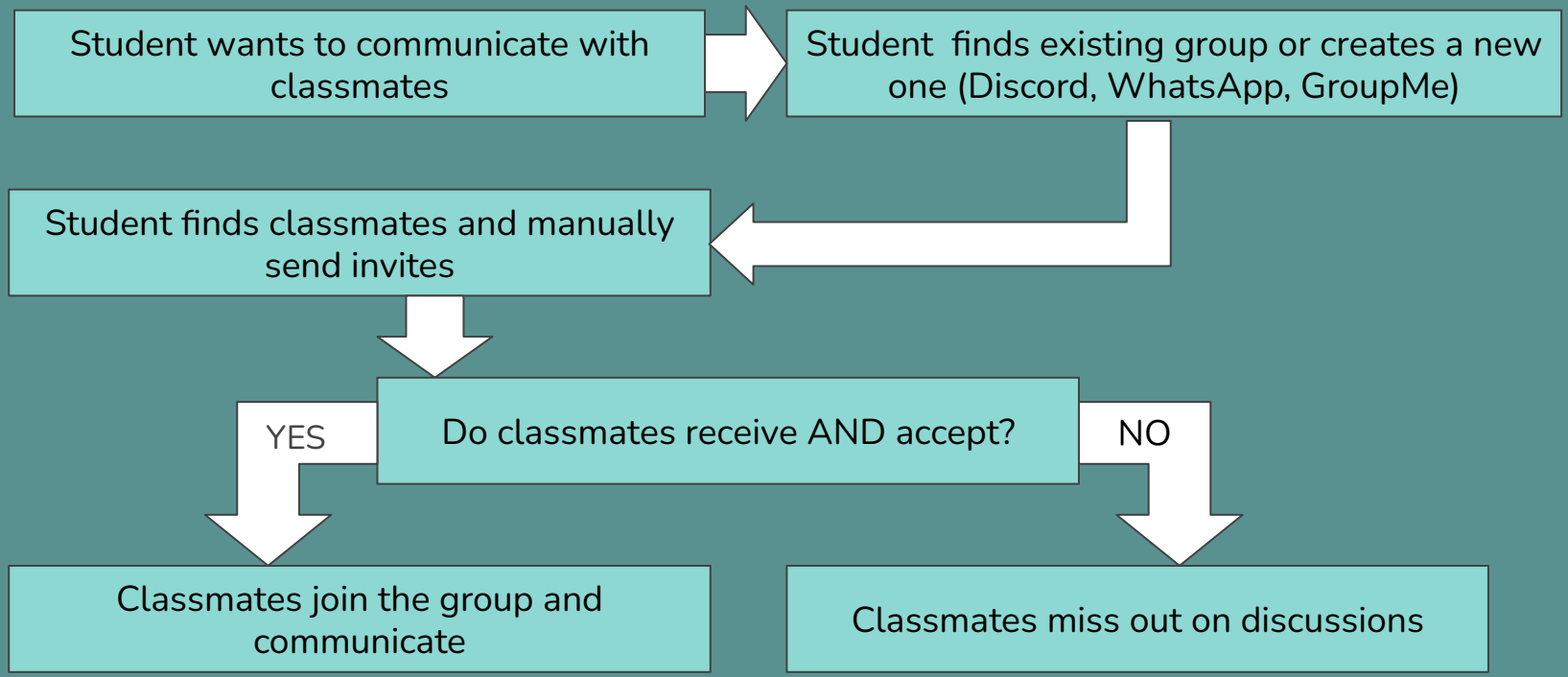
Current Process Flow

1. Student enrolls in a course.
2. Search for an existing group chat.
    a. Discord, GroupMe, WhatsApp, Slack
    b. May need to ask your classmates if one already exists.
3. If one doesn't exist, manually create a group chat.
    a. Platform choice is dependent on who creates the group.
    b. No standardized communication platform (each course may vary).
4. Send an invitation link (could expire?) to your classmates.
5. Student who receives/finds the invitation can join.

Solution Statement

Classes Together will eliminate the time lost by manually sending out invitations and reentry of course and academic information into a new profile. It will also provide an informal setting still academic oriented.

Solution Process Flow



What it Will Do

- Allow students to sign in to the platform.
- Display course communities based on student enrollment information.
- Provide a space for students to communicate informally with classmates.
- Organize communities by semester and then into courses.
- Simplify access to course groups without requiring students to create and distribute invitations manually.

What it Will Not Do

1. It will not replace Canvas or other LMS platforms.
2. It will not be the method for instructor-to-student communication.
3. It will not require students to manually create and distribute casual course groups.
4. It will not require students to download a third-party software.
5. It will not require students to register for an additional account.
6. It will not keep course communities active indefinitely.

Competition Matrix

	Informal	Academic	Course Information Already Present	Course Invite Always Open
Canvas	No	Yes	Yes	No
Google Classroom	No	Yes	Yes	No
Discord	Yes	No	No	No
GroupMe	Yes	No	No	No



Development Tools

Major Functional Components

1. User Authentication
2. Course Enrollment/Dashboard
    a. Displays active/inactive courses.
3. Course Communities
    a. Displays semester-specific community for that course
    b. Only students enrolled in that course may have access
4. Discussion System *(real-time messaging or forum-based..?)*
5. Notifications for unread or new activity
6. Community Lifecycle (archive/read-only when semester ends)

Major Functional Components Diagram

Risks

Real World Product vs Prototype Table

Feature	Real World Product	Prototype
User Authentication	University email or SSO	
Course Enrollment	Automatic university sync	
Course Dashboard	Actual student courses	
Course Communities		
Database	Stores user and course information	

References

- Pronto. “Communication: A Key Element of Student Success in Higher Education · Pronto.” Pronto, 17 May 2021, https://pronto.io/communication-key-element-student-success/. Accessed 28 Oct. 2026.

Appendix